

Customer Journey Map

Project Name: Smart Library Request Workflow in ServiceNow

Date: 3 July 2026

1. Discover & Access

Goal: Find and access the Smart Library Request Workflow in ServiceNow.

Interactions:

- Student/Librarian logs into ServiceNow instance
- Navigates to Service Portal
- Searches for 'Smart Library Request' or browses library services
- Opens the Library Management catalog

Positive	Negative	Opportunity
Service Portal provides centralized, easy-to-find access to library services.	Users unfamiliar with ServiceNow may struggle to locate the service.	Create a prominent bookmark, email notification, or dashboard widget for quick access.

2. Browse Catalog

Goal: Explore available books and understand current inventory.

Interactions:

- View full book catalog with real-time availability
- Search by Title, Author, ISBN, or Keywords
- Filter by status (Available, Issued, Lost)
- View detailed book information (description, location, copies)

Positive	Negative	Opportunity
Real-time, searchable catalog with clear availability status gives students confidence.	Users may be overwhelmed by too many search options or large catalog.	Implement smart search, recommendations, and filters for browsing experience.

3. Select & Initiate Request

Goal: Create a borrow request for the desired book.

Interactions:

- Click 'Request Book' button on catalog
- Confirm book selection and request details
- Form auto-fills student ID and name (if logged in)
- Set desired borrow date

Positive	Negative	Opportunity
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Auto-populated student details reduce form completion time; clear confirmation of selections.	Required fields may cause validation errors if incomplete.	Add request templates, suggested due dates, and request prioritization options.
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4. Submit Request

Goal: Submit the request and receive confirmation.

Interactions:

- Review request summary
- Click Submit button
- Receive request number and confirmation message
- Email notification sent to student with request details

Positive	Negative	Opportunity
Instant request number and confirmation provide peace of mind and reference for tracking.	Students may not immediately receive email notification.	Send SMS or push notifications; display live status on dashboard immediately.

5. Librarian Review & Approval

Goal: Librarian evaluates and approves/rejects the request.

Interactions:

- Request appears in Librarian dashboard/queue
- Librarian reviews request against inventory
- Librarian approves or rejects request with comments
- Decision triggers automated notification to student

Positive	Negative	Opportunity
Librarian has clear view of all pending requests; automated workflow reduces manual coordination.	Delays if librarian is busy or unavailable; no SLA enforcement visible to librarian.	Implement SLA tracking, escalation rules, and workload balancing across multiple librarians.

6. Automatic Status Update

Goal: System automatically updates book status upon approval.

Interactions:

- Flow Designer processes approval decision
- Book status automatically changes to 'Issued'
- Borrow request status updates to 'Approved'
- Student receives notification of approval

Positive	Negative	Opportunity	
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No manual status updates required; inventory accuracy ensured; student receives instant notification.	If Flow Designer fails, status may not update; student unaware of technical issues.	retry Add error logging, SLA mechanisms, and dashboards status for updates.
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7. Book Pickup & Handoff

Goal: Student collects approved book from library.

Interactions:

- Student visits library during operating hours
- Provides request number to librarian
- Librarian locates and hands off book
- Optional: QR code scan or barcode to complete handoff

Positive	Negative	Opportunity
Clear request number enables quick book retrieval; librarian can prioritize based on request queue.	Library hours may not suit student schedule; lost books cannot be tracked in system.	Implement notification reminders, extended hours, and barcode/RFID tracking for pickups.

8. Return Book

Goal: Student returns borrowed book.

Interactions:

- Student returns book during library hours
- Librarian scans/records return
- Book status automatically changes to 'Available'
- Request status updates to 'Returned' or 'Completed'

Positive	Negative	Opportunity
Return is recorded in system; inventory updated automatically; book available for next student.	No enforcement if student returns late; lost books hard to track.	Send return reminders before due date; implement fine calculation for overdue returns; add tracking.

9. Track & Manage (Dashboard)

Goal: Students and librarians monitor request progress and library performance.

Interactions:

- Student views personal request history and status
- Librarian accesses dashboard showing request queue, approval rate, SLA compliance
- Manager views reports: Most Borrowed Books, request trends, utilization metrics
- Generate reports for resource planning and decision-making

Positive	Negative	Opportunity
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Real-time dashboards provide transparency; managers can make data-driven decisions on resource allocation.	Initial setup of dashboards may be time-consuming; users may not understand metrics.	Create role-specific dashboards; add predictive analytics for popular books; export reports.
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